

**An Artistic Dialogue between Iran and India:
Iranian Inspiration and Indian Implementation, the Concept of *Charbagh***

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إِنَّ اللَّهَ جَمِيلٌ يُحِبُّ الْجَمَالَ

God is beautiful and loves beauty

God is beautiful and loves beauty. This famous Hadith of Prophet Muhammad aptly describes the beautiful world created by God and its reflections in art. The basic premise of this paper is that the original inspirational source of the *charbagh* has been drawn from Persia and adapted and implemented in India. This paper is divided into three parts. The first part discusses the genesis of the *charbagh* in Persia which goes as far back as the 6th century BC. The second part deals with the adaptation of the Persian concept of *charbagh* in India. This pioneering task was carried out by the Mughals as seen in the gardens of Humayun's tomb, Kashmir and the famous Taj Mahal. A vivid representation of the *charbagh* is also seen in Mughal miniature painting, examples of which will be explored. The *charbagh* is the terrestrial interpretation of the concept of the divine gardens of paradise as revealed in the holy *Quran*, the most spiritual of Islamic texts. Therefore, the third part delves into the spiritual and allegorical aspects of the *charbagh*.